SUMMARY · MK 1 ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR & MANAGING PEOPLE · WEEK 1

Strategizing Your Life — Living by Design

Week one starts not with organizations but with you. The logic: you can't lead others well if you don't know where you yourself are going. It introduces three pillars of a life strategy: Purpose (why), Values (how) and Self-Awareness (who).

Material

1 The paradox: we plan everything except our own lives

At work we routinely plan KPIs, budgets, projects — even holidays — in great detail. But for the biggest question — *what kind of life do I actually want?* — most people never sit down and think it through. Life then runs on **autopilot**: study choices, career and lifestyle are shaped mostly by parents', bosses' or society's expectations.

The core message: **stop living by default, start living by design.** A life strategy is not a rigid map but a **compass** — it gives direction and is recalibrated as circumstances change.

2 Pillar 1 — Purpose (Why): your North Star

Purpose is the fundamental reason behind everything you do. Not salary, title or approval — but *the mark you want to leave*. The material notes that people with a clear purpose tend to be happier, live longer and bounce back faster from setbacks.

Tool: Ikigai. This Japanese concept finds purpose at the overlap of four circles:

- **What you love** — activities that energize you.
- **What you're good at** — natural strengths and skills.
- **What the world needs** — problems you're drawn to solve.

- **What you can be paid for** — so the passion is economically sustainable.

Hitting only two or three circles leaves a gap. Good at it and well paid but don't love it → burnout. Love it and the world needs it but no pay → hard to sustain.

Writing a purpose statement: use the formula *"I exist to [action] so that [impact]."* Example from the slides: "I exist to inspire others so that they believe in their own potential." It doesn't have to be perfect — write what feels true now and refine it.

3 Pillar 2 — Values (How): your decision filter

Values are principles you refuse to compromise. If purpose answers "where to", values answer "by what means". Most people *inherit* values from family or environment without consciously choosing them.

Two states:

- **Integrity** — actions match values. It feels calm.
- **Friction** — actions contradict claimed values. This is the root of most inner conflict; the discomfort is a *signal* to heed.

Finding your values (3 steps):

1. **Recall your proudest moments** — what values were you honoring?
2. **Recall your angriest moments** — what values were violated? Anger points precisely at what matters.
3. **Narrow to a top 5** — e.g. Freedom, Growth, Integrity, Connection, Courage, Service. These anchor hard decisions.

Daily check: *"Did my actions today reflect what I say I believe?"*

4 Pillar 3 — Self-Awareness (Who): two mirrors

A striking fact from the slides: **85–90% of people believe they are self-aware but aren't.** Only about 10–15% truly are, through active reflection and feedback.

Self-awareness has two mirrors:

- **Inner mirror (internal)** — how clearly you see your own thoughts, emotions, motivations.
- **Outer mirror (external)** — how accurately you know how others experience you. Often surprising, sometimes uncomfortable, always useful.

They rarely match. **Growth happens when you close the gap.** Example: you see yourself as "firm"; your team sees you as "harsh". With only the inner mirror you'd never know.

Toolkit: journaling (write to discover, not just record), feedback loops ("What do you see in me that I might not?"), personality frameworks (MBTI, Enneagram, StrengthsFinder, DISC — as mirrors, *not fixed labels*), and mindfulness (training the gap between stimulus and response).

5 The two mirrors in one picture: the Johari Window

Deep dive

Self-awareness has two sides: what you know about yourself and what others see. The Johari Window maps them.

↕ Top: known to others · bottom: not known to others

Open Known to you and others.	**Blind spot** Others see it, you don't — shrink it with feedback.
Hidden You know it, others don't — shrink it with disclosure.	**Unknown** Discovered through new challenges.

↔ Left: known to self · right: not known to self

10-minute exercise

Ask three people for one strength and one thing to reduce; patterns across two or three answers are real blind spots.

6 Putting it together: a 4-step blueprint

1. **Know yourself** — audit values, strengths and patterns honestly.
2. **Define your purpose** — a simple, personal statement.
3. **Set aligned goals** — goals that honor your values and serve your purpose, not society's expectations.
4. **Review regularly** — a living practice, not a one-time document.

Identity-based living. The question shifts from *"What do I want to achieve?"* to *"Who do I want to become?"* Become the person for whom the goals are a natural outcome. Strategy without identity is just a glorified to-do list.

```
Purpose + Values + Self-Awareness = a life on your own terms
```

7 Life audit: does your time match your values? Deep dive

Purpose and values only matter when they show up in your calendar.

Wheel of Life (example)

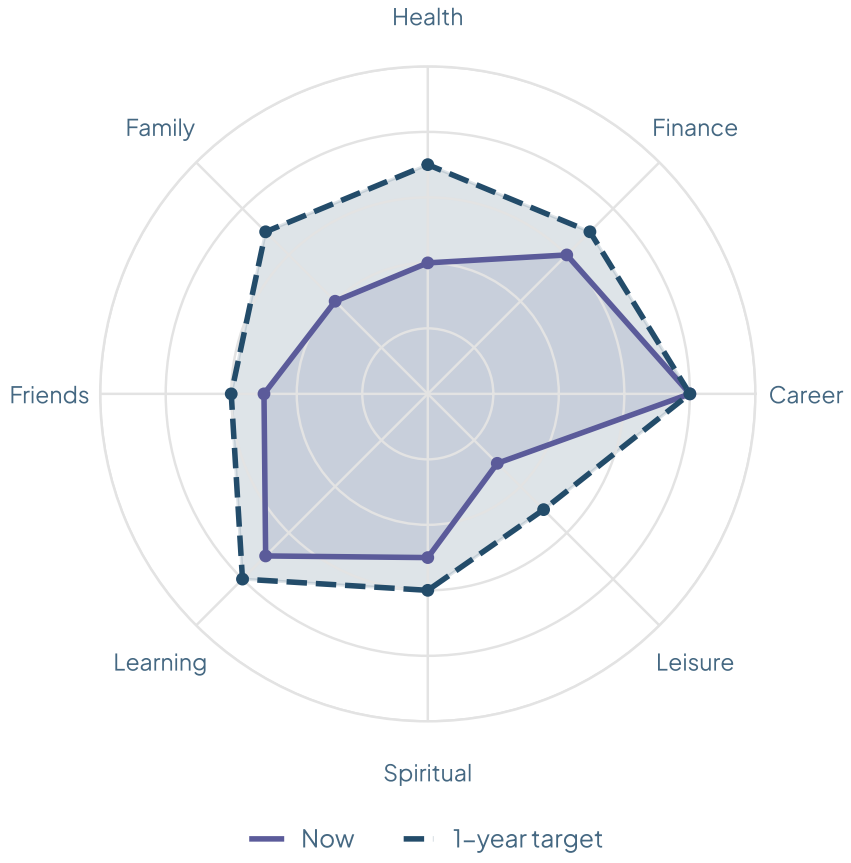


Illustration. Score each area 1–10 for yourself.

An illustrative Wheel of Life: a dented wheel shows neglected areas.

Example: 168 weekly hours vs stated values

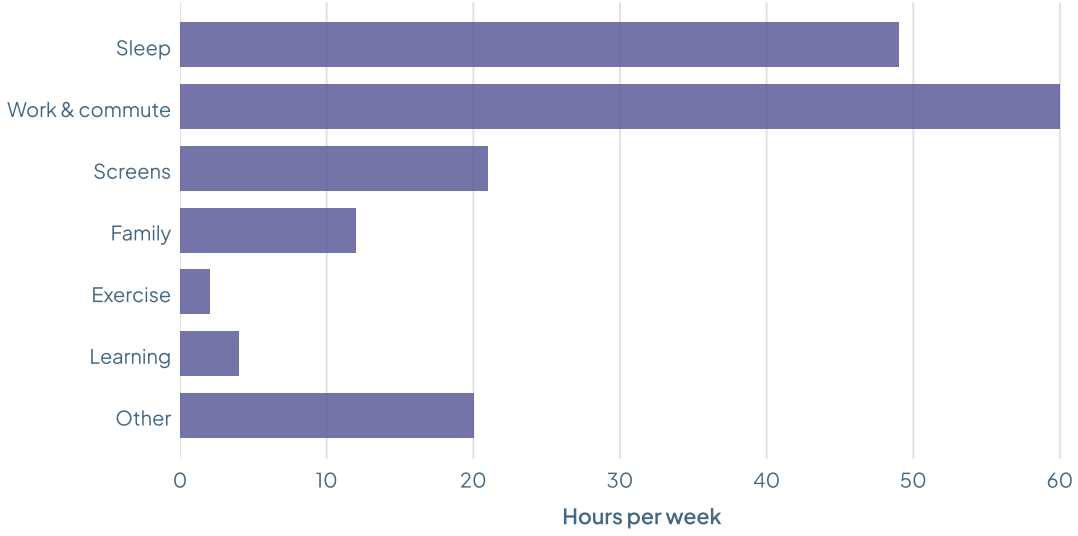


Illustration: 12 hours for family and 2 for exercise show a strategy not yet lived.

Step	Action
Log	Track a week of time
Compare	Match against 3–5 core values
Decide	Cut one thing, add one
Repeat	Review monthly

The "later" trap

Career investments pay quickly and visibly; family and health pay slowly, so time drifts to the fast payoff (Christensen).

8 Ikigai in more depth: the four overlaps and what is missing

The slides draw Ikigai as the meeting point of four circles. To use it, understand the **two-circle overlaps** as well. Each overlap has its own "feel", and what's missing usually shows up as a specific complaint.

Overlap	Made of	If you only reach this, it feels…
Passion	What you love + what you're good at	Personally satisfying, but "useless" and financially unstable
Mission	What you love + what the world needs	Exciting and meaningful, but unpaid and not yet skilled enough
Vocation	What the world needs + what you can be paid for	Secure and useful, but like "someone else's job" — no passion
Profession	What you're good at + what you can be paid for	Comfortable and established, but empty — boredom or burnout

How to use this table

Instead of asking "what is my ikigai?" (too big), ask "which circle is weakest right now?". If your job fits three circles but you don't enjoy it, the step isn't to resign straight away, but to find the parts you do enjoy and grow them (for example mentoring or an innovation project).

Academic note. The four-circle diagram is a popular Western adaptation. In the original Japanese thinking (for example the psychiatrist Mieko Kamiya), ikigai is simpler and more everyday: "what makes life feel worth living" — family, a hobby or a small routine, not necessarily paid work. So don't feel you've failed if your ikigai isn't a career yet.

Why purpose matters scientifically

The slides say people with a clear purpose live longer, are happier and recover faster. A frequently cited study is Hill & Turiano (2014, *Psychological Science*): in data on more than 6,000 adults followed for 14 years, people with a stronger sense of purpose had a lower risk of dying, and the effect held across ages. Purpose also supports *resilience*: a setback reads as an obstacle on the road, not proof the road is wrong.

9 Self-awareness research: four types, and asking 'what' rather than 'why'

The slide figures (85–90% believe they're self-aware, only 10–15% actually are) come from research by organisational psychologist Tasha Eurich (published in *Harvard Business Review*, 2018, "What Self-Awareness Really Is"). The same research combines the two mirrors into four types:

↕ Internal self-awareness (inner mirror) →

Introspectors High internal, low external. Understand themselves but never check how others see them. Risk: big blind spots.	**Aware** Both high. Know who they are and their effect on others. This is the target.
Seekers Both low. Don't yet know themselves or how others see them. Often feel "lost".	**Pleasers** High external, low internal. So focused on pleasing others they forget what they want.

↔ External self-awareness (outer mirror) →

A surprising finding: introspection can mislead. People who keep asking "*why* am I like this?" tend to build stories that may not be true and become more anxious. Eurich suggests switching to "*what*": not "why did I get angry in the

meeting?" but "what triggered me, and what could I do differently next time?". "What" questions lead to action.

A second finding: the more senior, the lower self-awareness tends to be. The more senior someone is, the fewer people dare give honest feedback. So leaders need to build feedback channels deliberately (for example "loving critics" — 2–3 trusted people asked to be candid).

10 Worksheet: a one-page life strategy

Combine all of this week's tools on one page. Fill it in honestly and review it every 3 months (step 4 of the blueprint).

Part	Prompt	Example answer
Purpose statement	"I exist to ___ so that ___."	I exist to build empowered teams so that public organisations serve people better.
5 core values	Proudest moment? Angriest moment? Narrow to 5.	Integrity, Growth, Family, Courage, Service
Strengths & blind spots	What do 3 people (feedback) and tests (DISC/StrengthsFinder) say?	Strengths: analytical, decisive. Blind spot: interrupting.
Target identity	"I am someone who…"	I am a leader who listens before deciding.
3 goals for 12 months	Does each goal serve the purpose and respect the values?	Finish P3MD well; exercise 3×/week; family dinner 4×/week
Proof in the calendar	Which small weekly habits prove that identity?	One 1-on-1 a week without interrupting; 10-minute journal every Sunday night

Identity-based living in practice

The slide's idea of "become the person first" matches James Clear's *identity-based habits* (*Atomic Habits*, 2018): every small action is a "vote" for the identity you choose. Instead of targeting "run 10 km", decide "I am

someone who exercises" — and prove it with any small action today (for example a 10-minute walk). The big goals follow as an outcome.

Key takeaways

1. Most people live by default; a life strategy means living by design.
2. Three pillars: Purpose (why), Values (how), Self-Awareness (who).
3. Ikigai = overlap of what you love, are good at, the world needs, and can be paid for.
4. Purpose formula: "I exist to [action] so that [impact]."
5. Misalignment between values and actions = inner friction.
6. Self-awareness has internal and external mirrors; growth = closing the gap.
7. Ask "who do I want to become", not just "what do I want to achieve".

Case studies

Case & worked answers

Link to work: why this belongs in an OB class for future leaders

Two young managers at a state-owned company are offered promotion to a troubled unit. Manager A accepts immediately because "higher title = better". Manager B first asks: does this fit my purpose (say, "building empowered teams")? Does the unit's culture clash with my value of integrity?

Both may accept — but B goes in with **clear reasons and boundaries**. When pressured to "massage" a report, B already has a decided value filter. That's the practical function of the three pillars: **making hard decisions faster and more consistent.**

It's also the foundation for later weeks: personality (W2), motivation (W3) and leadership (W4) all start from self-knowledge.

Practice questions

Try answering first. The answer key is below each question.

1. In the framework, the Purpose pillar answers…

A. Who am I?
B. Why do I do this?
C. How do I act?
D. What is my target?

Answer: B. Purpose = why; values = how; self-awareness = who.

2. Colleagues see you interrupt but you don't notice. Which Johari area?

A. Open
B. Hidden
C. Blind spot
D. Unknown

Answer: C. Known to others, not to self = blind spot; reduce it with feedback.

3. The main role of values in a life strategy is…

A. Setting the salary you want
B. Acting as a filter for decisions
C. Replacing long-term goals
D. Making others like us

Answer: B. Values filter decisions when dilemmas arise.

4. Why does time drift to work rather than family or health?

A. Work is always more important
B. Work pays off fast and visibly, family slowly
C. Family needs no time
D. Health can't be planned

Answer: B. Without a conscious strategy we chase fast payoffs.

5. The most honest first step of a life audit is…

A. Write a grand vision
B. Log a week of time use
C. Make resolutions
D. Compare with friends

Answer: B. Time data reveals real priorities.

Sources

- Week 1 Strategizing Your Life.pdf